



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

kṣamā+śīpho dhairya+vigāḍha+mūlaś* |
cāritra+puṣpaḥ smṛti+buddhi+śākhāḥ |
jñāna+drumo* dharma+phala+pradātā |
na*utpāṭanaṃ* hy* arhati vardhamānaḥ || 13.65 |
baddhāṃ* drḍhaiś* cetasi moha+pāśair* |
yasya prajāṃ* mokṣayituṃ* manīṣā |
tasmin jighāṃsā tava na*upapannā |
śrānte jagad+bandhana+mokṣa+hetoḥ || 13.66 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 13, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine the Bodhi tree as described here, a potent symbol of enlightenment itself. The first verse paints a vivid picture: its roots are patience, deeply grounded and unshakable. Its flowers are good conduct, blossoming with beauty and grace. Memory and wisdom form its branches, reaching towards the sky. This is a tree of knowledge, promising the fruit of dharma, of righteous living and understanding. The verse concludes with a simple yet profound truth: such a being, flourishing in goodness, should not be uprooted.

This imagery flows into the second verse, which speaks of the Buddha's intention: to liberate beings from the bonds of delusion that tightly bind them. It highlights the compassionate heart that seeks to free us from suffering. The verse then directly questions the impulse to harm such a being, one who is tirelessly working to release the world from its self-imposed chains. It seems utterly contradictory to seek to destroy someone dedicated to universal liberation.

These verses from the Buddhacarita offer guidance for your own spiritual journey. Consider the qualities of the Bodhi tree within yourself: Are your roots grounded in patience? Are you cultivating good conduct in your daily life? Are you nourishing the branches of memory and wisdom through mindfulness and learning? The Buddha's example challenges you to embody these qualities, to become a source of dharma for yourself and others. Furthermore, it asks you to examine your own intentions. Are you seeking to liberate yourself and others from suffering, or are you clinging to the chains of delusion? In a world often driven by self-interest and aggression, these verses remind you to cultivate compassion, understanding, and a commitment to the well-being of all. Choose to nurture the seeds of enlightenment within, rather than succumbing to destructive impulses.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you actively nurture your own inner Bodhi tree today, strengthening its roots of patience and allowing its blossoms of good conduct to flourish?